

■ Step-by-Step Rice Export Procedure

Pakistan → DRC (Democratic Republic of Congo)

■ Step 1: Documents Needed for Rice Export to DRC

Document	Issued By	Mandatory?
Commercial Invoice	You prepare	■ YES
Packing List	You prepare	■ YES
Bill of Lading (B/L)	Shipping line (MSC/Maersk)	■ YES
Certificate of Origin	FPCCI / Chamber of Commerce	■ YES
Phytosanitary Certificate	DPP via PSW portal	■ YES
Fumigation Certificate	Licensed fumigation company	■ YES
PSW Export Declaration (GD)	PSW portal / Clearing Agent	■ YES
BIVAC/OCC Inspection Certificate	SGS, COTECNA, Bureau Veritas	■ YES (DRC)
Weight & Quality Certificate	SGS/COTECNA at mill	■ YES
SGS Quality Report	SGS Pakistan	■ Recommended
Halal Certificate	PNAC or recognized body	■ Recommended
Insurance Certificate	NIC / EFU / Jubilee General	If CIF contract

■ Step 2: ESFCA Bank Account (Exporters' Special Foreign Currency Account)

Where to Open	HBL, MCB, UBL, Allied Bank, Meezan Bank
Required Docs	NTN + CNIC + Business Registration (sole trader/company) + REAP Membership
SBP Rule	Retain 50% of export proceeds in USD — remaining 50% can be converted to PKR
Do NOT deposit	Your own PKR money — only foreign currency from export proceeds goes in
When to Open	Before your first shipment — so LC can be routed directly to your bank

■ Step 3: LC Arrives at Bank — What To Do Next

1	Bank Review	Bank calls you — LC received. Review: rice specs, quantity, price, port, expiry, docs required.
	LC Copy to Mill	Give factory only a COPY of LC with specs page. NEVER give original LC to factory.
3	Production	Factory produces rice to your specifications.

	Inspection	Arrange SGS/COTECNA inspection at mill before loading.
5	Shipment	Container loaded on vessel at Karachi port.
	Collect Docs	Collect: B/L, invoice, packing list, C/O, phyto cert, inspection cert.
7	Submit to Bank	Submit ALL documents to YOUR bank within 21 days of B/L date.
	Payment Released	Your bank sends docs to DRC buyer's bank → buyer's bank releases payment → credited to your ESFCA.

■ LC is your payment guarantee — keep the original with your bank at all times.

■ Step 4: Form E — How to Get It (IMPORTANT UPDATE)

STATUS	Form E is ELIMINATED — SBP abolished it in 2024.
CURRENT PROCESS	PSW portal automatically generates PSW Financial Instrument when you file your GD (Goods Declaration). This replaces Form E completely.
WHO HANDLES IT	Your clearing agent handles through PSW portal — nothing extra needed from you.
BANK STEP	Bank registers your export proceeds against the PSW reference number automatically.

■ Step 5: Mill Rice Inspection (Before Loading)

Who to Contact	SGS Pakistan, COTECNA, or Bureau Veritas — book at least 3–4 days before loading.
What is Checked	Moisture content, broken %, grain length, foreign matter, pesticide residues.
Where	At mill or warehouse — before container is sealed.
Documents Issued	Weight Certificate + Quality/Grade Certificate.
Cost	~\$150–300 per container.
Why Mandatory	DRC (BIVAC/OCC) requires this — without it, shipment is held at Matadi port.

■ Step 6: Customs Clearance for Rice Export

1	GD Filing	Clearing agent files Goods Declaration on PSW portal. HS Code: 1006.30 (milled white rice).
	Customs Check	Customs selects green channel (auto-cleared) or physical examination.
3	If Examination	Customs inspector checks bags at port/dry port. Ensure all docs match GD exactly.
	Gate Pass	Customs Export Gate Pass issued — container allowed to leave for Karachi port.
5	KPT Docs	Agent submits docs to Karachi Port Trust (KPT) for terminal container release.

C o s t	Agent Fee	PKR 8,000–15,000 per 20ft container.
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■ Step 7: Phytosanitary Certificate

Issued By	Department of Plant Protection (DPP) — Ministry of National Food Security
How to Apply	Apply on PSW portal → select 'Phytosanitary Certificate' → fill rice details (species, quantity, origin, consignee in DRC)
Inspection	DPP inspector visits warehouse/port — checks for pests, disease, moisture.
Timeline	Certificate issued within 2–3 working days after inspection.
Cost	~PKR 2,000–5,000 per shipment.
Important	Valid for ONE shipment only — get a fresh certificate for each container/shipment.
Why Required	DRC port (Matadi/DGDA) requires this — without it, shipment is rejected and returned.

■ Step 8: Documents To/From Factory (Mill)

YOU GIVE to Factory	YOU GET from Factory
■ Purchase Order (your PO to mill) ■ Copy of LC — specs page only ■ Packing instructions (bag size 25kg/50kg, labeling, HS code) ■ Quality spec sheet (broken %, moisture %, grain length)	■ Sales Invoice from mill ■ Mill Analysis Report (moisture, broken %, grade) ■ Fumigation Certificate ■ Loading Certificate / Weight Slip (from weighbridge) ■ Truck Receipt / Delivery Challan (when rice leaves mill)

■ Keep mill invoice safe — both customs and bank need it during document negotiation.

■ Step 9: Mill / Company Agreement — Key Terms

Clause	What to Write
Quality Guarantee	Broken max 5%, moisture max 13.5%, no foreign matter — as per SGS spec.
Delivery Deadline	Rice must be ready within X days of Purchase Order.
Shortfall Penalty	If mill delivers less than ordered, penalty per MT applies.
Rejection Right	If SGS inspection fails, you can reject shipment — mill replaces at no cost.
Price Lock	Price fixed at PO date — no changes after signing.
Fumigation	Mill is responsible for fumigation before loading container.
Document Responsibility	Mill provides: mill invoice, fumigation cert, weight slip.
Payment Terms	30% advance + 70% after loading OR after LC payment received in your bank.
Legal Requirement	Agreement signed + stamped on Rs. 500 stamp paper with witnesses.

■ Step 10: Freight / Insurance / Bill of Lading

Term	What It Is	How to Manage
FREIGHT	Cost to move container Karachi → Matadi	Rate: ~\$2,800–3,500 per 20ft FOB contract: buyer pays CFR/CIF contract: you pay
INSURANCE	Covers cargo loss/damage during sea voyage	Get from NIC / EFU General / Jubilee General Cost: ~0.3–0.5% of cargo value Required if CIF contract
BILL OF LADING	Most important doc — title/ownership of goods. Without it, buyer cannot collect rice at Matadi	Issued by shipping line after loading 3 original B/Ls issued Send 1 to buyer's bank, keep 2 Submit to your bank within 21 days

Can One Clearing Agent Handle Everything?

■ YES — a good Karachi clearing agent handles: • PSW/GD filing • Customs clearance • Port documentation (KPT) • Container booking coordination • Freight booking liaison ■ They do NOT handle: • Phytosanitary Certificate (DPP — you apply on PSW) • Certificate of Origin (FPCCI/Chamber — you apply) • SGS/COTECNA inspection (you book separately) • BIVAC/OCC inspection (DRC side — buyer's agent handles in DRC) Tip: Find a clearing agent with DRC export experience — ask if they've done Karachi → Matadi before.

■ MSC vs Maersk — Which Container Line for DRC?

	MSC	Maersk
Service to Matadi	MSC Iroko Service (via Pointe-Noire)	Maersk 23H Matadi Feeder
Transit Time	~32–35 days	~35–38 days
Frequency	Weekly	Bi-weekly
Price	Slightly cheaper	Slightly higher
Reliability	Very good on Africa routes	Excellent tracking & docs
RECOMMENDATION	■ BEST CHOICE for DRC	Good backup option

Start with MSC — stronger West Africa network, more frequent sailings to Matadi, competitive rates. Use Maersk as backup when MSC is fully booked. Pro Tip: Your clearing agent + freight forwarder can be the SAME company — look for a Karachi freight forwarder with an Africa desk who handles everything from GD filing to B/L collection.